

Phase 3 Assessment Rubric

BUS331 Investment Committee Simulation | Written decision package and oral defense

How the assessment works

Canvas remains the authority for due dates, submission mechanics, and the project's course-grade weight. The criteria below preserve the written/oral balance while assessing both individual role ownership and the committee's integrated decision.

Written package	Oral defense	Submission authority
50% of the Phase 3 assessment	50% of the Phase 3 assessment	Canvas controls due dates, file requirements, and the project course-grade weight.

Evidence chain the committee must defend

Phase 1 client discovery and macro evidence must visibly control Phase 2 security selection, allocation, IPS compliance, stress results, corrections, and the Phase 3 recommendation. Role ownership is individual; the final decision is collective.

AI may challenge a judgment or help debug a process, but it is not evidence. Material claims must be verified with approved sources, including properly documented FactSet retrievals where required.

Written decision package

Criterion	Weight	Decision-ready standard
Evidence quality & technical accuracy	25%	Claims, calculations, formulas, sources, FactSet retrieval records, as-of dates, and portfolio metrics are correct, comparable, traceable, and interpreted; required licensed evidence is submitted privately through Canvas and AI output is never treated as evidence.
Security analysis & selection	20%	Bond, mutual-fund, and ETF choices follow real candidate comparisons and address return drivers, risks, costs, duration/credit or benchmark/style exposure, liquidity, diversification, Issuer Reality Checks, and monitoring.
Client suitability & IPS compliance	20%	Each recommendation traces to Phase 1 client needs and guardrails, and the IPS scorecard tests all relevant objectives and RRTLLU constraints.
Portfolio integration & risk response	20%	Weights, diversification, overlap, risk exposures, bear-case results, breaches, corrective trades, and re-tests form one internally consistent portfolio decision.
Role ownership & team decision trail	15%	Each analyst's owned work is identifiable, peer-reviewed, and integrated into votes, dissent, action items, visual exhibits, and the Analyst Decision Log.

Oral Committee Defense

Every member owns a role and must understand the integrated recommendation

Criterion	Weight	Decision-ready standard
Live defense & evidence response	25%	Members answer the question asked, use relevant evidence and calculations, acknowledge uncertainty, and defend or revise the judgment under challenge.
Individual role ownership	25%	Each member demonstrates command of the work they owned and can explain the decision, evidence, AI challenge, verification, and limitations.
Team integration	20%	The committee presents one coherent chain from client discovery through security selection, allocation, stress results, correction, and final recommendation.
Client suitability & risk compliance	20%	Members can show where client needs changed the portfolio, explain the strongest bear case, and defend compliance or the corrective action taken.
Clarity, professionalism & visual evidence	10%	The team communicates concisely as client-focused professionals and uses legible exhibits that make the recommendation, trade-offs, and evidence visible.

Defense standard

The panel may direct any question to any member. Answer the question asked, use the relevant evidence or calculation, acknowledge uncertainty, and explain whether the challenge changes the decision. A strong answer can defend, qualify, or revise the recommendation; it cannot substitute confidence for evidence.

Committee Question Bank

Prepare across roles - not only for the section you present

Client and Macro Strategist

- Which Phase 1 client fact or guardrail most changed the final portfolio, and where can the committee see that change?
- Which macro assumption matters most to this recommendation, and what evidence would cause the team to revise it?
- Which unresolved client information gap remains material, and how did the portfolio avoid pretending it was known?

Fixed-Income Analyst

- Why does the selected fixed-income exposure fit the client's cash-flow horizon better than the strongest alternative?
- What happens to price and income if rates or credit spreads move against the position, and which duration or credit evidence supports that answer?
- What did the Issuer Reality Check reveal about cash flow, leverage, interest coverage, maturities, and the largest issuer-specific risk?

Fund and ETF Analyst

- Why is this mutual fund or ETF the best implementation vehicle after fees, trading costs, taxes, liquidity, and benchmark/style exposure?
- What did the look-through Issuer Reality Check reveal about the most material relevant holding, overlap, concentration, and actual diversification?
- Which performance or tracking comparison is decision-useful, and how did you make the periods and as-of dates comparable?

Portfolio Manager and Risk Analyst

- Which risk contributes most to the portfolio's bear-case loss, and which client goal is therefore most exposed?
- Show the IPS compliance test. Which metric came closest to a warning or breach, and what action follows?
- If the committee rejects one proposed adjustment, what alternative preserves the client goal and what new trade-off does it create?

Any committee member

- What was the team's strongest initial judgment that changed after AI challenge and human verification?
- Which FactSet retrieval most affected the recommendation, how did you interpret it, and where is the licensed-source evidence retained under course policy?
- Which source or calculation carries the most decision weight, and what are its limitations?
- What is the strongest reasonable case against the final recommendation?
- What monitoring trigger would force the committee to reconvene before the normal review date?

Submission Readiness

Use this checklist before the Phase 3 committee decision and Canvas submission

Written package

- ☐ The recommendation is stated clearly for all assigned clients.
- ☐ Every material claim, input, calculation, and as-of date is traceable.
- ☐ Bond, mutual-fund, and ETF decisions show real comparison and instrument-specific evidence.
- ☐ Required Issuer Reality Checks and FactSet retrieval records are complete.
- ☐ Each holding traces to a Phase 1 client guardrail and has a portfolio job and monitoring trigger.
- ☐ The full IPS scorecard and bear-case test are complete; every breach is corrected and re-tested.
- ☐ The Analyst Decision Log records initial judgment, AI challenge, verification, and final reasoning.
- ☐ Required licensed-source evidence and final student work are prepared for private Canvas submission.

Oral defense

- ☐ Each member can defend owned work and explain the complete decision chain.
- ☐ The committee can show where a client need or constraint changed the final portfolio.
- ☐ The team can explain the strongest bear case, closest warning or breach, and corrective action.
- ☐ Every member can identify the most decision-useful source, calculation, limitation, and monitoring trigger.
- ☐ Visual exhibits are legible and make the recommendation, trade-offs, and evidence visible.